

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

a course in the in-depth study of the qur'an

تَدَبُّرٌ

TADABBUR

Entering Each Sūrah Whole — Context, Connection, Center,
and Change

Before we open the tafsīr of a single āyah, we first stand at the gate of the sūrah itself — its time, its ties to what surrounds it, its center, and its shape. Only once that map is drawn do we begin to walk through the verses.

This is not tafsīr for information alone. It is tafsīr that asks, at every gate: what does this sūrah want to change in me?

CONTEXT - CONNECTIONS - CENTER - STRUCTURE - TRANSFORMATION

أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ أَمْ عَلَى قُلُوبٍ أَقْفَالُهَا

“Will they not ponder the Qur’ān deeply — or are there locks upon their hearts?”

SŪRAH MUḤAMMAD · 47:24

Student _____

Sūrah _____

Session _____

The Gateway to the Sūrah

Eleven gates we pass through before entering the āyāt of any new sūrah

1 Makkī or Madanī مَكِّيَّة أَمْ مَدَنِيَّة

Defined chronologically — before the Hijrah or after, regardless of where the revelation physically occurred. Where scholars differ, we state the disagreement rather than presenting one view as settled.

2 Time of Revelation رَمَانُ التَّوْل

Early, middle, or late Makkah — or which stage of Madīnah? What was the Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, and the early community living through, so we hear the sūrah as its first audience heard it.

3 Reasons for Revelation أَسْبَابُ التَّوْل

We carefully distinguish an authentically reported occasion of revelation from mere surrounding history — not every sūrah or āyah has a specific sabab.

4 Link to the Previous Sūrah مَنَاسَبُهُ آخِرِ السَّابِقَةِ بِأَوَّلِ هَذِهِ

What thought, question, warning, or promise carries from the ending of the sūrah before into the opening of this one?

5 Beginning and Ending مَنَاسَبُهُ أَوَّلِ السُّورَةِ بِآخِرِهَا

We compare the sūrah's opening and closing vocabulary, themes, and imagery, and see how the ending answers and completes the beginning.

6 Link to the Next Sūrah مَنَاسَبُهُ السُّورَةِ بِمَا بَعْدَهَا

Why does what follows feel so fitting after this sūrah? Are its themes continued, contrasted, answered, or developed?

7 Its Virtues فَضَائِلُ السُّورَةِ

Every narration is graded before it is shared — Ṣaḥīḥ, Ḥasan, weak, or disputed. If no authentic sūrah-specific virtue exists, we say so plainly.

8 Its Name اسْمُ السُّورَةِ

Why is it called by this name? Is it established from the Sunnah, and does it carry other authentic names? What does the title already reveal?

9 Its Central Message مَخَوْرُ السُّورَةِ

After reading the whole sūrah: if its message were one sentence, what would it be? Every passage is then read in relation to this axis.

10 Its Structure خَرِيطَةُ السُّورَةِ

The sūrah divided into its natural movements — not artificially, verse by verse — so it is seen as one connected whole, not a list of unrelated āyāt.

11 The Question Before We Begin مَاذَا تُرِيدُ هَذِهِ السُّورَةُ أَنْ تُغَيِّرَ فِيَّ؟

Why do I need this sūrah? What disease of the heart does it treat? What should be different in me by the time I finish it?